

A cold text from a number you didn't save

9:12 AM • INBOUND MATCHED AGAINST EVERY THREAD, CONTACT, AND INVOICE YOU HAVE

What it already knows: the number wasn't in your phone and the message gave no company, yet it recognized the sender from your own history in under a second. It read the relationship before you finished reading the text.

The message that came in

A short text from an unknown number. No name, no signature, no context.

UNKNOWN NUMBER • +1 (415) 555 ... • 9:12 AM

"Hey, are you all still doing the custom runs? Had a project come up and your name was the first one I thought of."

Here is who this is.

Who this is

Resolved from the phone number against your archived correspondence and your old order records.

Renata Calderon

DIRECTOR OF PROCUREMENT • SUTTER & VALE

A former customer, not a new lead. Sutter & Vale ran a standing account with you for roughly three years and then went quiet. Renata was your day-to-day contact for most of that run. She placed the orders, she signed off on the specs, and she is

the one texting you now from a personal number rather than her work email. That detail matters: this is a warm, informal reach, not a formal RFP.

The history

Reconstructed from order records and the email thread, oldest to most recent.

YR 1 TO YR 4

Active account. Sutter & Vale ordered on a steady cadence, roughly every six weeks, mostly custom runs.

PEAK

About \$186K in their best twelve months. They were a top-fifteen account at the time and growing.

~26 MO AGO

A delivery on a rushed order arrived late and partly out of spec. The thread shows it was resolved, but the tone cooled afterward.

~24 MO AGO

The account went dark. No formal cancellation. Orders simply stopped. No win-back was ever attempted.

LAST CONTACT

A one-line reply from Renata declining a reorder, then silence. That was the last anyone here heard from Sutter & Vale until today.

Why they likely went quiet

Three reasons drawn from the old threads. None of them are loyalty problems, which is why this is recoverable.

The botched rush delivery was never fully made right

SERVICE

The late, out-of-spec order got a refund but no follow-through. The thread ends with a polite "we'll be in touch" that no one acted on.

A price increase landed the same quarter

PRICING

Your standard rate moved up about nine percent right after the delivery issue. The timing made it read as a worse deal than it was.

Their internal champion likely changed

CHAMPION

Renata's emails referenced a "new ops lead reviewing vendors" shortly before the account went dark. The relationship lost its inside advocate.

Recommended moves

Three steps to win the account back, each with an owner. The order matters: rebuild trust first, then talk terms.

Reply yourself, today, warm and personal

NOW

She came to you by name and from a personal number. A founder-level reply within the hour signals the account matters. Do not delegate the first touch.

OWNER • YOU

Quietly own the old delivery miss and offer a goodwill rate on the new run

THIS WEEK

Acknowledge what went wrong two years ago without dwelling on it, then price the new project at the pre-increase rate for the first order. Cheap insurance against the two things that pushed them out.

OWNER • HEAD OF SALES

Put your best operator on the first delivery and brief them on the history

ON ORDER

The whole relationship rests on this run landing clean and on time. The ops lead should know exactly what went wrong before so it cannot happen twice.

OWNER • OPS LEAD

Drafted reply

Already written in your voice and waiting for you to review. It names her, picks up the warmth she opened with, and quietly closes the door on the old issue without making her relive it.

Renata, good to see your name come up. Yes, we are very much still doing custom runs, and honestly I am glad it was us you thought of first.

I will be straight with you: the last project we ran for Sutter & Vale did not go the way either of us wanted, and that one was on us. I would like the chance to make

the next one the easy one. Tell me what came up and a rough timeline, and I will get you something this week. I will keep an eye on it personally.

Most teams would catch this from a churn report a quarter later, long after the window to reply warmly had closed. Command Room caught it in the first sentence of a text from a number no one had saved.

COMMAND ROOM • RELATIONSHIP INTELLIGENCE • RUNS THE MOMENT AN
INBOUND LANDS • NAMES AND FIGURES ARE ILLUSTRATIVE